

Digit Test Process

We primarily tested four new features in InDesign and Quark: Layers, transparency support, tables and saving to Web and outputting to PDF. We created a test document in Word which was then placed in InDesign and Quark. To these documents, we added certain images and applied different effects to them, specifically testing the options for tables and layers.

For InDesign, we tried importing a table from a spreadsheet as well as a Word document. We applied different styles in the document and then created

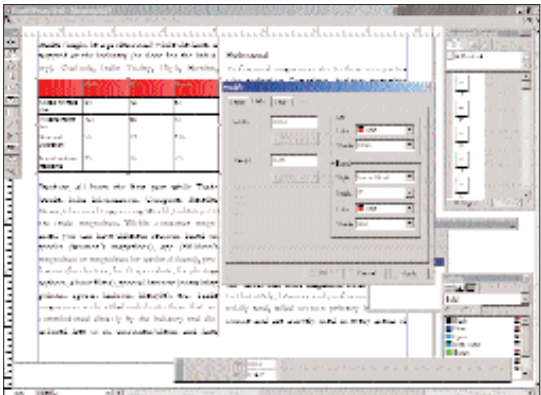
an XML document using the tags applied to the stylesheets.

We separately created a Web document in Quark with tables, forms, rollovers, and other features and tried recreating the same document in InDesign.

A feature we couldn't test was how the files outputted on to a positive. Earlier versions of Adobe InDesign had reported problems during outputting, though Adobe claims to have resolved these issues.



With Quark you can add an image to a new layer and check whether you want to keep it visible or locked



In Quark, only row or column level manipulation is possible

for this to happen. InDesign wins round No. 1 comfortably. Score: Adobe 1 Quark 0

Round 2: Layers

How would you like to create multiple versions of the same document without having to layout two different files? Say, a text-only version and another version with all images present? Quark has finally introduced Layers (something that's been present in PageMaker for ages and in InDesign since the beginning), and gone a step

ahead in adding better features. With Layers, you can place your text in one Layer, and the images in another, or have two versions of the opening visual for your cover with the text remaining the same.

The difference is that in Quark you can make the text runaround the Layers even if they are hidden—a feature absent in InDesign. This makes it very simple to create a text-only version (say, for proofing purposes), while retaining the images in another layer. It's more tedious to work with Layers in InDesign. You cannot click an element and add it to another Layer as in Quark. The workaround is to duplicate the Layer on which the element is and then go back to the original Layer and delete it. Round 2 goes to Quark. Score: Adobe 0 Quark 1

Features at a Glance		
	Adobe InDesign 2.0	QuarkXPress 5.0
Tables	Create tables, import from Word and Excel directly, cell-level manipulation possible	Create tables, imports from Word as tabbed text, row- or column-level manipulation possible
Layers	Create as many layers as you like, colour-code them, or lock and hide them. Shifting an item from an existing layer to another layer is problematic	Create as many layers as you like, colour-code them, lock them and hide them. Options for disabling or enabling text runaround around hidden layers. Quite simple to use
Transparency	Can import transparent images, such as a Photoshop file, directly. Add Drop Shadow and Feather effects to image as well as text and work with different blending options	Can only import from flat files. For transparency you have to create a clipping path in the image. No text or image-handling effects present
Web	Can export as HTML or XML. However, HTML export isn't that good. Can Tag text as per stylesheets. Relatively easier to use	Can create a Web document with options for forms, rollovers, adding buttons, etc. A Web document outputs as you see on screen. XML tagging can be done but isn't all that easy to use
Text and document-handling	Adds number of features such as inserting page breaks or column breaks. Can add special characters or work with ligatures and open type fonts. Can create indexes and table of contents	Can create indexes and table of contents (using Lists option). Cannot insert page breaks or column breaks
Single highlight	Tables	Layers
Pros/Cons	+ Transparency and table features - Web export disappoints	+ Layers, Web document - Cannot export transparent documents directly
What's still missing	Storyboard editor, check spelling as you type, bulleted list options	Import tables from Excel, direct support for transparency objects, storyboard editor, spell-checker as you type, bulleted list options
Price	Rs 36,500 (Rs 8,500 for an upgrade)	N/A
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